Social Media Cessation

1. Introduction: Prior Evidence

Several experiments in adults have tested whether quitting or cutting down on social media improves mood, with mixed results. Some found improvements in positive mood (Allcott et al. (2020) , others found no clear effect (Asimovic et al. (2021) , and a few found that mood got worse (Walsh et al. (2024) . However, these studies recruited mainly adults, and none included participants under 18. It therefore remains unclear whether quitting or cutting down on social media improves mood.

2. References

- **Allcott et al. (2020)** Allcott, H., Braghieri, L., Eichmeyer, S., & Gentzkow, M. (2020). The welfare effects of social media. *American Economic Review*, *110*(3), 629–676. https://doi.org/10.1257/aer.20190658[1][2]
- **Asimovic et al. (2021)** Asimovic, N., Nagler, J., Bonneau, R., & Tucker, J. A. (2021). Testing the effects of Facebook usage in an ethnically polarized setting. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *118*(25), e2022819118. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2022819118[1][3]
- **Walsh et al. (2024)** Walsh, L. C., Regan, A., Okabe-Miyamoto, K., & Lyubomirsky, S. (2024). Does putting down your smartphone make you happier? The effects of restricting digital media on well-being. *PLOS ONE*, *19*(10), e0306910. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0306910

3. Use of AI

I used Gemini Notebook (Google; accessed 21st October 2026) as part of my literature review to extract details from 14 studies. I checked all cited claims against the original papers.